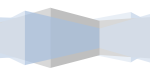




PRAKASH HEGADE

I Fell in Love
With a Geek



~*~*~*~*~*~*~*

I fell in LOVE with a GEEK

By Prakash Hegade

Smashwords Edition

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For any query or questions kindly email: prakash.hegade@gmail.com

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Note and a Request

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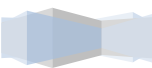
Preface

Here is a quick note. I am sure most would be disappointed to know that one who picked the phone when Drishti called was not Charan. Charan met with an accident the previous night and is NO more. It's kind of sad, I know, but that's how this book will end. The story eventually gets to that part.

LOL, NO. I was just messing up with you. LOL. I loved your expression though. You got to find out what in 'point of fact' happens.

There is a boy and there is a girl. Then there are days where they are falling in love with each other (they know, but they don't want to accept that). That's the plot of this novel. Love surely does not need a story. All it needs is two people (not strictly and specifically, and not up for debate). There is an asshole and a geek and there is a philosophy. Every love story has its philosophy. However and but, again, this one has buckets of however's and but's.

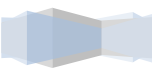
- **Prakash Hegade**



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One

The Overrated School Life

I have this hunch that school life is overrated (I am labeling it as ‘hunch’ just to stay away from quarrels, but I believe its overrated). ‘Student life is a golden life’ - that’s what people quote. Is that because what we dream of in school stays in school? Stays far from reachable? A faraway cloud that melts and disappears with time? A life as expensive as gold and not easily reachable?

A singer doesn’t sing anymore and only uploads recordings on Instagram which undoubtedly needs more practice. A painter who once had several numbered paintbrushes does not even have colors anymore. A writer now does copy-paste assignments. A sports enthusiast was said ‘no’ at home and was first asked to get an engineering degree. A dancer now watches reality shows and cries. Once an aspiring actor, now makes TikTok videos. Most of my friends who once dreamed to reach skies are probably going to end up working on the 10th floor. Many others are busy watching, discussing, and voting over scripted reality shows. People have been divided based on religion and politics. Youth is apparently wasted in nonsense.

I felt useless after my tenth. I passed with second class, god knows how. Okay, not only school life, but board exams are overrated as well! I really don’t know what happens



there. I studied day and night in the last ten days to exams and managed a second class. I had to give entrance exams again to get admitted. I did study well because things in books were making sense to an extent. I got admitted to a good enough college but the fees did bother me a lot. I had committed myself to study hard but that motivation did not remain for more than a day. 'Hard' transited to 'hardly' real quickly I say!

I did not hate classes 11 and 12, but neither did I like them. There was no purpose on why anyone was doing it. I felt that all of my friends and the people I hated were in a rush, going somewhere and no one knows where. Everyone wakes up at 5.00 am, and sleep at they-don't-know-when. Everyone is running in-between tuition classes, college classes, breakfast, lunch, discussions, etc.

Chaos.

Everyone wants a medical or engineering seat. Now, I did not want to be one in the herd. But somehow picking up engineering looked fancy.

I was the MOST confused soul for I had blurred dreams. Maybe I was complaining about everything because that was an easier thing to do. I was fed up with my own rants. If I were to listen to myself, I would have probably killed myself by now. LOL.

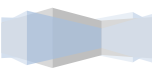


Disgusting. I had to change myself for my own better tomorrow and better myself. Most importantly, I was willing to change.

Often, I felt the need to pause and reflect. I did.

Beauty is now in filters and editing tools. The girls I see in photos, I don't see them in real. Maybe I see them but I sure don't recognize them. I don't understand this gym culture. I have known most do things which are not good for the body in the long term. It's not natural. But then, it is easy to fall into that trap. Looks attractive and addictive. Because I am already useless, I decided to pick up something, good or bad. The gym did feel like my forte. I registered myself with no second thoughts. But I had promised myself that I would not allow anything unnatural or illegal to get inside my body. God promise. Being a vegetarian, I had limited options and I was happy with it.

Bat shit. I am a little messed up with the sequence. Bear me and my rants.



Two

Dad and Me. No, Me and Dad.

This conversation has been special to me in many ways. You will know ‘why’ as I did ‘how’. I regret on few things though. For today, I feel to rewind and live those days again. I wish I was back in class 11 and class 12 days. I wish I could relive my childhood days. I now undoubtedly know what I want but the time has already passed.

Beauty and irony of life?

Me – ‘Dad, I promise, I will pass my class 11 and 12.’

Dad – ‘How about you score well as well?’

Me - ‘No. I can’t. I am hoping you will back me up with a management seat.’

Dad – ‘Management seat where? In my business? You have it!’

Me – ‘No. The commons.’

Dad – ‘Engineering?’

Me – ‘Yes. Yes.’

Dad – ‘Do you need that degree? You already have all the skills to run my business.’

Me – ‘I just want to have my college life. I deserve it.’

Dad – ‘At the cost of my hard-earned money?’

Me – ‘Dad, please.’



Dad – ‘Okay. But,’

Me - ‘Yes, But?’

Dad – ‘I want you to make the best of these two years. And the four ahead.’

Me – ‘Like what?’

Dad – ‘You figure it out.’

Me – ‘I will hit the gym regularly. Does that count?’

Dad – ‘You will do that for yourself. Something else. Bigger. Larger.’

Me – ‘I will work on it.’

Dad – ‘Yes. Please. I will be sitting you in 6 years’

Me – ‘Okay.’

Dad – ‘And mind you. I am pretty serious about it. So is your mom. I am a businessman. I need back the money invested in you. With profit and returns.’

Me – ‘Which dad says that?’

Dad – ‘Me. I do. I just did. Now get lost.’

Me – ‘ahh!’

I seriously needed a role model. Right away!



Three

The Rolling MODEL

Models and all I can think about is Fashion TV. I hate this new pay and use the service model. I can't see the channels that I want to. I can't subscribe to what I want. I know there is a cell phone but I am also a TV person. I am not comfortable yet to tell my parents to subscribe to the channel I need. I prefer a few things on TV and they are meant to be seen there.

For more than a few oddly couple of months, I kept jumping over different role models. I had Elon but his shoes are a lot bigger. I had him in mind for a day and then I reminded myself that, for now, let me be real and pick someone I could relate to. Then I took an actor. I liked the movies he made. I started reading about his lifestyle, his story and his social handles, oh my god, that guy is a psychopath. Don't ask me who. He just lost a fan! I had a lot of people coming up in my mind but they were all far from reality and my needs. The more I dig into it, the more I was exposed to darker sides. Before I turned Vantablack, I had to do something.

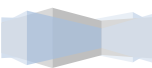
No, I cannot relate to modern Instagram influencers. I cannot trust a guy of age 23 talking about life experiences, born and brought up with a golden spoon. I cannot listen and adapt to a guru who does not understand our generation or the way we



grew up. I want someone who has got his principles right which applies even to people 100 years down the line. I want a bigger picture and not a bugger.

I could not think of any of my school teachers as I hardly remember what I did in school. My mistake. I though remember standing near the gate and counting the fools who entered and left the school campus. That was my favorite school pass-time activity. No wonder I was an asshole. No wonder I still am.

I did scratch my head a lot on the matter. For a moment I wanted to declare myself as my role model. Is that even possible? Is that acceptable? Then, I don't know how I had this Eureka moment. Like striking lightning - I think of Drishti.



Four

Dumbo, Still Better

No. Drishti isn't any good. She will teach me with her 'how not to be' skills. She can be my role model. Let me be more clear and specific. Oh, there are so many things.

One. She is weird.

Two. In school, I have never seen her head held up. She always used to walk with her head down. Really, where will you find such girls these days? She used to raise her hand and head high to answer any questions in class. That is exactly when our hands and heads used to go down.

Three. She is not dark, she is not fair – but brown. She is not tall, she is not short but perfect. Her eyes are neither black nor brown but different.

Four. I can't describe how she looks. Let's settle with okay-okay. Moreover, it's not a concern at all. My perceptions, my ass!



Five. She studies a lot. She is hardworking (I guess she is not a smart worker. Only a hard worker). Class topper. She is boring. She is the last person I would want to hang out with on earth considering no other planets have lives.

Six. She sucks. Totally not my type.

Now, why would she be my role model?

One. Maybe I am jealous of her and let's be honest. I don't want to be like her but I want to bring out results like her. I am going to stalk her for a while. Check her out. Follow her and stick along.

Two to Six. Repeat whatever I said in One.

17 September 2012 - I finally find and fix my role model as Drishti. It's going to my secret and no one else will know that. I need not even call her a role model.



Five

Stay at Sight

Certain things are god crafted. I saw Drishti in the same pre-university college as I got admitted. Certain things continue to be god crafted. I saw her in the same engineering college as well. I made sure she doesn't notice me in pre-university. I preferred to stay away. I saw that she was hyperactive on Goodreads. She was less of Facebook and Instagram. She hardly took any pictures of herself. Ah, I know. I am sure she is not photogenic. The book in her hand would look better than her.

The two years' pre-university went by really fast. I could not make any good friends. I did take the gym seriously. Studies, I managed to pass. I kept exploring videos on YouTube and started making note of things that excite me. I had things to take care of that I had promised to my dad. But in two years I had nothing.

Engineering first year, nothing changed. Neither we. The whole year looked like it was crafted to waste everyone's time. But over the year, I did notice one thing that had changed – Drishti. She looked different. I hate to say that the 'different' was in a good way. She was also kind of famous because there was this rumor that she utters 'asshole' a lot. I could not believe it but it was fun to so I did. There was also a rumor that she had her gang of assholes and for me that was hard to believe. Had she

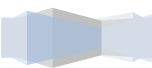


changed? Stopped studying and stopped being sincere like she was before? She hadn't probably. She still topped the class.

But this asshole thing, I don't know why, I liked it.

I am Charan and she is Drishti and I am pretty sure though we are not this year, next year, when we enter our departments, we will be in the same class as they sort students in alphabetical order. I will get to see her often, hopefully.

Drishti, why am I even concerned about what and who you are?



Six

The Class Elections

I wanted to be elected as a class representative. I made some strategies for the speech. I would be including the name of Kalyan. He is a good singer and I know him pretty well. He has a fan following and I am sure he can get me some votes. I am going to take Drishti's name as well. She has a gang. She will convince her gang. She is already surprised to see me on the campus. I just hope in the same surprise, she will vote for me as well. I have had talks with Sangarsh. He stays in the hostel and he will get me some votes. I have heard another guy who is from the hostel, who is talking to people about votes, not many like him there. They like me or not because they don't like him, I might get votes. It also depends on who else is going to stand for election.

On the day, during the speech, I was scared like hell. I could not stop myself from seeing Drishti. She was right there. 7th bench. She seemed to be staring at me. I felt I might forget my speech. However, I did mess up with some parts but Shreyas said I did well. He always gives honest feedback and that's why he is my friend.

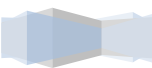
Drishti was wearing black that day. Black is my favorite color too. I was sure she would vote for me. Based on her expression when I took her name, I am sure she would have voted for me. Her eyebrows had gone up and head lifted a little. My eyes have been



following her all through don't know why. However, I did win with a close margin. I wanted to thank Drishti so I decided to give a winning speech. But when I went to stage, I could not gather the guts to take her name. I just thanked all and rushed back.

Drishti doesn't know that I have her number saved for years. I immediately created a class group. I wanted to add her first but then I stopped. Added few guys first. Then 2-3 other girls and then added her. Just to make sure she is not the only girl's number that I have saved, I saved a few other numbers too. In a week I had to mute and delete a few because they kept updating their status very often and a few of them with hundred pictures.

She had saved my number. I could see her status.



Seven

The First Conversation

A day later, evening around 8.00 pm there was a ping from Drishti.

‘Hello, Charan.’

‘Hi.’

‘Was surprised to see you.’

‘I knew you were here since the first year.’

‘You look different. It was not easy to recognize.’

‘Thanks to the gym. The only good thing I did.’

‘I agree.’

‘How mean of you. By the way, I heard that you call me an asshole?’

‘Aren't you?’

‘God, that hurts.’

‘That’s okay. Listen.’

‘Listening.’

‘Congratulations.’

‘Thank you.’

2 minutes later.



‘Did you finish class 12?’

‘Mean again. In the same college where you did, Drishti.’

‘Have you been stalking me?’

‘Why should I?’

‘I don’t know. Because you are an asshole!?’

‘That definitely does not hurt. I won't answer that.’

2 minutes later.

‘Charan, do you walk to college every day?’

‘Hey, have you been stalking me?’

‘Asshole!’

2 minutes later

‘Good Night’

‘GN’

Now, the one with ‘Good Night’ was her. ‘GN’ was me. It was spontaneous and then I realized that there was a difference. After this, I decided to type ‘Good Night’ henceforth. No, not to all. But to her at least.



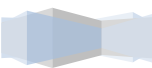
Eight

No Nut November

My love for beard started with No-Shave November. The first year was difficult. I had hairs growing here and there. I frequently shaved though parents warned me not to do that. Internet said it was okay! Then I started shaving when they both were out but somehow they got to know. It was easy. I looked like a pretty little girl when I shaved. LOL.

For the next year, I had grown the love for the beard. That was the most precious thing for me hands down. We had formed a WhatsApp group of beard guys. Not all guys were into it. I forced Shreyas and he agreed. I even made him shave. I had to take a blade and force him in October so that he is prepared for November. From the years then on it made hardly any difference as I always had a beard on. It made me look good. Strangely, that's what even my mom said. My bathroom shelf had more bottles. It's strange that men can have a grooming kit too.

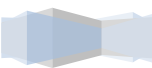
Recently, we also had No Nut November. I gave up on day four. It was impossible. The more you resist over something, the more you feel like getting it done. Maybe if it was not a challenge, I could have pulled more days. I just could not resist myself for very of my reasons. This is our secret, not supposed to be told anyone but Shreyas



successfully managed to complete No Nut November. I had to clear my doubt if he really was a guy. How is that even possible? Shreyas was proud of it and he was equally ashamed to share it with anyone. I did tease him to update that as his WhatsApp status. I almost did snatching his phone. It would be fun.

I mean, think of all those achievements that we have and not proud of sharing it with anyone! I have many. Many. How many such you have on the list?

The day I broke my No Nut November, I had noticed Drishti staring at me. She gave me a Hard time. Hard time, I say!



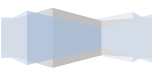
Nine

My Secret List

As I said, we all have a list. There is a version of me that no one knows. I am happy not sharing it with anyone. Even Shreyas does not know most of it. But I like who I am under the blanket. I like the darker side of me. Unless it does not harm anyone else, I don't think it must be a problem.

Though I say I don't care, I get excited when I see a confession on me. I enjoy knowing that people have been talking about me. I feel happy that I have been the point of the talk. I like the things I do at 3.00 am. I am ashamed of telling that to the public. But, I don't have any guilt of being that. I don't mind watching chick-flicks. I don't know what's wrong in guys watching them. I question at times why pink is a girl and blue is a boy. I proudly wear my red shoes.

I have been taking an unusually long time for bathing lately. I have a fear that my parents have noticed that. But, nothing of that is under my control. We are what we are. Why be ashamed though?



Sometimes, when I am in class, looking at board and slides when I am bored and insides, the pictures of movies that I watched last night come into my mind. I just keep praying that no one asks me to stand up. That would be awkward.

Sometimes, I am so tired, I just want to walk home and sleep. That remains only in the morning. Then, post-lunch, everything seems normal. I don't know where the energy kicks in from. I and Drishti are in the same laboratory batches. I am looking forward to teaming up with her sometime. No. Nothing like you think. I just want to know her a little better.

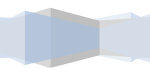
Shreyas keeps teasing me at times. He says she keeps staring at me. Trust me, it's these friends who spoil us big time! They create stories and we fall prey for it. I guess I am falling prey to Drishti. I will be careful. Just with teases, stories, rumors, relationships ban jaate hai. God! And break-ups bhi!

Most important of all, I like black. I feel black hides me from many things. I feel connected to black. I don't have any explanations. Just like I like momos. It soothes the mouth, throat, and tummy.

Most important of all, I am least concerned about this degree. I just want to spend the best of my time in the time I have. I want to take all that I can from here and build



something of my own. I see that Drishti has that too but she does not open up. Maybe she has family pressures to keep on. I am a free bird and I am willing to create a flock.



Ten

Because She is in the Picture

I made sure that even if I did not attend all the classes, I managed to see her at least once. I started the reading club and made her the head. I did at-times visit the meetings and stayed for minutes. I never told anyone I had started reading. I wanted to remain an asshole.

There were two occasions where I did shopping ONLY for her. One was during the class trip. I wanted to purchases suitable clothes, sleeveless, where I could show off my body. I purchased everything new from top to bottom. I was shirtless in most of the trip. HELLO, it was a beach trip. I did catch her staring at me several times. Shreyas said many did but I don't care.

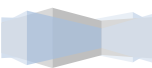
There was another day that I need to mention. I was hyper excited that day. I did shop for a new pair of dress. The t-shirt had an abstract painting on it. I love abstractions. Abstractions are mind-dependent. I sprayed myself an extra dose of newly purchased perfume that day. I knew Drishti looked confused. I guess she wanted to find out what I was up to. Because she even asked Shreyas about it and he did me. No, I did not answer to any. It's my personal favorite celebration day. Not to be known by any. It was the fifth anniversary of making Drishti as my role model. I wanted to celebrate



that day. She was an inspiration for me in several ways, like it or not. I am also not sure how and why I specifically remember that date. I did have honey-cake that day. I hope it's her favorite. It's mine anyway.

I made sure that I was the first one to wish her on her birthday. First a personal message to her and then one in the group. She was equally responding. She used to wish me sharp at midnight. Not in the group but through personal message.

For all these things I feel for her, I blame my hormones. I blame the blood. I blame age. I blame my friends. I blame my class. I blame my university. I blame her. I blame everything but myself and me.



Eleven

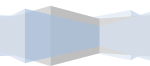
Embarrassment Bowl

What's yours? We all have a story that puts us into awkward situations. Mine, I still get chills when I think of it.

My mom, who was washing my clothes, comes out of the bathroom and gives me an 'I will kill you' look. I ask myself why she is showing me a pack of condoms. OH MY GOD, she found it in my pant pockets!

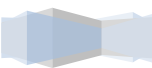
I was sweating and not sure of what to say. I said 'it's not mine' and put my head down. I don't know what she was thinking for half a minute, she then said – 'It's not good. Yet. Don't spoil your future. I know it's the age, but, I hope you are matured enough to understand.'

I could not respond to her for the moment. I just stood still. I was looking for answers of my own. What would I tell!? That evening I did tell her that I seriously did not know how it came in my pant pocket. No, I did not purchase it. Why would I. I am not sure if she believed it. I had no explanation.



I had worn that jeans at least 6 times before I put to wash. I had to track back on each day. I had been to college hostel rooms. Did anyone slip into my pants? Was it on purpose? Was it by mistake? Did anyone place it by mistake and then had a situation? How did it give birth in my pants? I did discuss it with Shreyas. I was not confident enough to discuss it with others. It would create unwanted problems. I and Shreyas tried hard to track each day event hour by hour. We could not get a clue. Not even one. I am guessing somewhere in the hostel. It's still a mystery for me.

It was the most uncomfortable week for me. The way my dad was looking and responding at me, clearly, he had got to know about it. I might never forget this in my life.



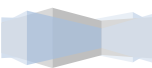
Twelve

The Sacred Wall

The sacred wall is the west wall of my room. The wall is painted crimson and I have kept that wall empty on purpose. The wall is my guru. It listens to all of my crap with no complaints. It knows the darkest of my secrets. For it has seen so much of me, so many of me, it sure has fallen in love with me.

When I am bored of binge-watching a series, when I don't want to do shitty assignments, when I feel like not talking to my friends anymore, when I don't want to listen to any songs, when I don't want to check out my mobile notifications, when nothing on TV excites me, when I want to be left alone, when life makes no sense, I look at the wall. The wall is my life hope.

The wall is my hope of imagination. Like society, it does not stop me. It does not tell me what to dream. It allows me to go anywhere. It makes me feel good about myself. It gives me hope. It gives me hope that there are good people around me. It alerts me that there is more to life than what we see. It tells me that the color of the wall can be changed. It can be decorated. It can be altered. It can be redesigned. The wall can be stuck with new posters. When it gets old, it can be replaced with a new one. It can have

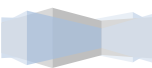


more posters. It can hold a collage. I can hang a key chain. I can hang my thoughts. The wall still stands.

I go lost in with my thoughts in the bathroom. Sometimes in the toilet. But nothing is better than getting blanked out in front of the wall.

The wall brings all the memories I had with everyone. It brings me Drishti. She comes often. I smile thinking of all the moments I had with her. I remember winning a debate competition with her. I remember having food from her plate. I remember arguing with her. I remember her standing beside me while canceling classes. I remember organizing class celebrations with her. I remember the quirky chat discussions. I remember so many things. I remember her. Gosh, she is beautiful. More from inside.

And all that I remember about her, I want to tell her.



Thirteen

Graduation

I was the most confused soul on the day of graduation. There were things that I was happy about, the things I would miss, and 'sad'.

Engineering did teach me a lot of things and I am proud of them.

- It is okay to wake up at 6.00 am to catch out on our favorite show episodes, even if it was never for a class.
- I learned that as long as it was with friends, a trip to any place was okay. Be it to an ice-cream parlor or Goa.
- It is okay to bunk classes and travel for a concert at the nearby place.
- It is okay to watch a chick-flick.
- It is okay to bunk classes and assignments to catch up on a movie first-day first-show.
- It is okay to dance like a mad monkey in the college tech fest.
- It is okay to get wet in the rain even though there is an umbrella in the bag.
- It is okay to fall in love with a bench, with a class, with the classroom windows, (with a classmate!?) and never with a course
- It is okay to tease a friend and kick him in the ass.
- It is okay to snatch friend's food and make sure they get none.



- It is okay to fight and patch up or just keep fighting.
- It is okay to everything another damn fucking thing.

I am going to be happy about the fact that no more the professors are going to trouble me. No one will call me at random and odd times to post an assignment. No one will call me asking for an extra class. No one will make me do useless works. No one will ask me to bring a chalk box. No one will ask me to set up the projector. No one will ask me to create google sheets. No one, no more will treat me like an unpaid servant. None of my classmates will torture me to cancel a class. No more hundreds of unread messages. Period.

All those trips, organizing events, roaming around in campus, campus on holidays and Sundays, those friends and gags, unplanned trips, funny class incidents, etc, etc, etc, I am going to miss them all. I am going to miss Shreyas the most. For he was the only person I know who wasn't wearing a mask. He was who he was. He laughed for stupid things. He was the most innocent person I ever met. He smiled for every other thing like an idiot. He would not know if anyone was taking advantage of him. I am going to miss him. He is moving out of the country for higher studies. I am sure he will excel wherever he goes. I feel, he has a part more in my life. I feel the future has more for us. Though we are parting now, I know the future will bring us together. I have a strong feeling over that.



My degree has taught me to be a better person. I have fallen in love with the campus. No matter what, its mine. I might hate it but I won't allow anyone or any outsider to shame or talk bad about anything even far-ly related to my college. It's in my blood. I will forever be in debt to it. Every space and corner here is a part of my story. And that story is beautiful.

Anthu mugit pa.

Tallying to all this happiness, there is one thing that makes me sad. I will not be able to see Drishti. She will move back to hometown and then take up a job. I might never see her. Unless, unless, I don't know. Drishti, one person, one reason, missing her weighs equal and more to all the happiness I have mentioned

*You were studious,
Never like me,
You were hard-working,*

*Never like me,
Came to class every day,
Never like me.*

*Why,
Why on the earth would you like me?*

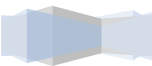


*You read,
You discuss books,
Hey, I do too,
But you don't know.*

*I am not like you,
Never with you,
Will you ever like me?*

*We did not talk much,
Or did we?
I felt it was too less.
I did not see you often,
Or did we?
The more, is less.*

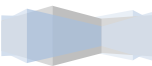
*You geek,
You call me an asshole,
Yes,
I really am,
For I am not able to tell you,
How I feel for you,
What I feel for you,
Do I really feel for you?
Yes,
I really am,
An asshole.*



*My heart beats faster,
When I think,
Of telling you,
That I might have,
Fallen in love with you.*

*This is where I pause,
Stand,
Scared,
And ask you,
“Do you love this asshole?”*

The day I was seeing-off Shreyas, I cried like a baby. Even Shreyas did. But for me, it was not just Shreyas. It was accumulated emotions of everything which had a stronger part of Drishti. I had thought she was a dumbo. She was nothing like I had thought of. Nothing.



Fourteen

Blue and Blue

I am blue and so is Drishti.

As colorless,

As colorful,

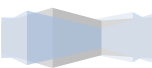
Between the blue and blue,

Disappears blue.

A shadow,

Searches soul.

You read that twice, thrice, but I am sure you will find the depth when I break it down
line by line for you. I will. Soon.



Fifteen

Her Call

Yes, we both are different and probably never meant to be together. Are we? I am so scared. Should I ask my dad, seek permission for 2 more years and take up the job? Or as I could not do anything as my dad wanted, should I shut my mouth and just get back to his business? Gosh, I am so confused. This will be a tough call. How do I tell my dad? Will he agree? It's been days. I don't like the fact that we just said 'bye' on the day of graduation. If anything that a day is adding is only more confusion. On one side is the list of things I want to try. On the other side is my dad wanting to include me in his business. On another side is a job with Drishti in it.

*I wish,
You could see,
What I scribble,
On the last pages of my book!*

*I wish,
You could see,
That there is,
Your name scribbled on it.*



I had dreams, blurred, 6 years ago and still are. I haven't still figured what I am good at. Maybe I must just get into my dad's business. What do I do? He is going to ask me someday soon. Should I just drop everything and go to higher studies? Why? Why am I so stupid? Is this all a temporary age attraction? Why can't I just ignore her?

Oh my god, she is calling me.

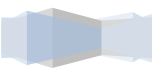
The first ring – should I pick up?

The second ring – should I pick the call?

At third,

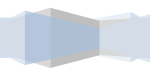
“Hello!” (I hear)

“Hey, Hello” (I say, with a shaky voice)



The End.

[If you would want to call it so anyways]



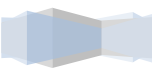
What Next?

Yes, there is more to geek and there is more to asshole. The remaining part of the story will be available during December 2020/January 2021. I know that's a long wait or maybe not. The characters Charan and Drishti have been around me and I want to do them better justice. I want to take it as my NaNoWriMo November 2020 project. Trust me, it will be beautiful and so will be the wait.

I have already set the plot and outline for what happens with Charan and Drishti. I had to fill in some plots and loopholes here and that is exactly what took time.

I want to end this here as much I don't want to.

P.S. I have been working on two almost complete projects 'i 4 you' (started in November 2016) and 'The Art of Ageing Gracefully' (started in November 2019). I want to release both before I take this work again.

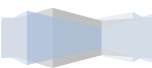


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About the Author

Prakash Hegade



Academician, always a research student and blogger who loves to read and write!

Blogs at: <https://itsphblog.wordpress.com>

Goodreads: <https://www.goodreads.com/prakashbh>

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